



Motion-Smoothing on SteamVR

SteamVR has introduced motion-smoothing so as to provide smoother gameplay for people using lower-end PCs. <https://digit.in/nov18-85-1>



A companion for your smartphone

A startup has launched a PALM phone that can be used when you want to avoid distractions from your smartphone. <https://digit.in/nov18-85-2>

onds ago for all I know. Time is meaningless when you can just be whatever you want to be, whoever you want to be, and live where you want. Waking up was horrible, but it was far worse talking to that damn software bot and realising that I wasn't alive again. Well not really, at any rate. I spent 14.23 billion dollars of my fortune towards research for cryogenic freezing of my brain, died at 77 in 2041, which was way too young for someone as rich as me, and woke up 307 years later as a damn app on some computer in some data center that is run by robots. I probably owned the darn data center at one time.

Anyway, after waking up and losing my temper with that stupid bot, I was finally put into my younger body and placed inside a poorly constructed replica of my office. I could tell it was a fake immediately. Even though I could reach out and touch everything and feel it all, it was all fake. Clever fakes, because it was very impressive to my 21st century brain that metals felt like metals, and my plush cedar wood cigar case felt just like an expensive cigar case should, but it wasn't my cigar case. It didn't have the nick in the side that was created when my eldest son tipped it off the table as a child. It didn't have the smell of my cigar smoke, which had seeped into the wood itself over the years. It wasn't mine, and it was the same for every item in that room. It's why I couldn't spend more than a day there. I chose to sit on a beach in Jamaica instead – not in summer because I hate the heat, but the winter there is perfectly balmy.

I met my family there as well. They came to see me on my private beach. Not that I would know they were my family. My wife decided to be Chinese that day, and although I love the Chinese, I couldn't wrap my head around the fact that this petite Chinese woman talking to me was the tall, brown-skinned, Indian goddess I had married in my late 60s.

She wasn't really the same person though. It was her alright, and she wasn't some knock-off like my cigar box, but it wasn't the woman I'd fallen in love with. She loved the freedom of the software world. It spoke to her on some primal level to be able to be who she wanted, where she wanted, in whatever body she wanted to be. My youngest son later told me that I should be happy she showed up as a woman, because she seemed to have spent the past 50 years in mostly male bodies – when she was human, that is... It took some time for me to figure that out. I'd assumed that people could be animals as well, and live a day as a frog, or a lion, or whatever they wanted, but that was only because I had a pathetic imagination. I was a numbers guy. Logic, calculations, markets, trends, number crunching... that was my thing. Fantasy was for the poor. I didn't dream, I made money and just bought other people's dreams.

Turns out, my way of living was long gone. No one wanted to live "life" anymore. No one wanted to be normal. No one wanted to be real. I'd woken up in a world where everyone was a gamer, or a comic book nerd, or a religious sycophant living out their dreams of being united with whatever saviour they prayed to.

My wife the actress spent her time playing the roles of all of the plays of Shakespeare, and all of the roles in her favourite books. She could be Lady Macbeth one day, each of the witches

for the next few days, and even Macbeth himself. Heck she could be Macbeth in Hamlet, and make up her own play as she went along. She'd probably be able to explain the myriad of possibilities better, and actually did a couple of times but I blanked when she was talking. We only spoke a few times in between her busy schedule of plays, and each time was for very brief moments. The last time we spoke I knew I wouldn't hear from her again, and I didn't care. This wasn't a world where human connections seemed important, and I was starting to understand that.

It was perhaps the reason why almost all humans were "jacked in" over 200 years ago (or that's what the digital librarian told me when I asked for news from the real world). It's where I learnt that I'm not an actual brain anymore. Although my brain was frozen in the hope that it would be transplanted into a younger body someday, it turned out that the world went virtual and what I paid billions for was available to everyone for free just a century after I died. Wealth, power, countries, wars... it was all gone. No one cared about anything material, and no one wanted to procreate. My son had a daughter, but that was where my family line ended. She was 22 when she "jacked in". They explained that term to me, but I didn't understand it. The most I could make out was that it involved downloading your brain into a computer, and then being put to sleep like an unwanted dog in a kennel!

It was different for me. For us, I should say Bill. We were frozen brains. It took a hundred years for the bots to painstakingly create a replica of my frozen brain, then test it. The bots captured a few of the humans still living outside the grid, jacked them in, dissected them, and froze their brains. They were then reconstructed from the frozen brains (like I would be later), and then the jacked in consciousness was matched to the zombie.

They had to get it right, and hundreds of outlaws were captured and forcefully jacked in for us to be able to come back. I'm told I was cryo zombie number #3476, which doesn't mean much, but more importantly, I was the fifth last of all. You're next Bill, then Mel, then Paul, and of course, Steve is last.

Paul and Steve they're not sure about yet. After all, Steve was frozen way back in 2011, and Paul in 2018. Cryo back then wasn't what it became much later when Mel passed, or the decade we both passed in.

It's a big deal to them of course. The bots have been programmed to worship Steve, Tim made sure of that before passing himself. It will take tests on thousands more outlaws before they even attempt to bring Steve back. Heck, the bots might decide to jack in all the remaining 3 million or so outlaws left in the world before they attempt to resurrect Steve. He's going to hate it Bill. As are you. I know I do. I can feel myself stopping to care, and just drift from one experience to another, jacked in and alone... slowly losing all drive and ambition, unable to even go mad, trapped in this digital coffin, awake, unable to scream... If you ever read this Bill, I hope I still care... about anything at all! Just in case I've changed for good, I wanted you to know that I thought of you my friend.

I really hope you never wake up Bill. 